Building Bridges of Partnership, Unlocking New Avenues of Growth.









FOREWORD

India and the Republic of Belarus share a relationship built on mutual respect, longstanding diplomatic engagement, and complementary economic strengths. Over the past three decades, both nations have steadily expanded cooperation across trade, industry, science and technology, education, pharmaceuticals, heavy engineering, agriculture, and cultural exchanges. As the global economic landscape continues to evolve, new opportunities are emerging to elevate this partnership into one driven by innovation, industrial collaboration, resilient supply chains, and sustainable economic growth.

This Knowledge Paper examines the institutional framework governing bilateral relations and presents practical recommendations to strengthen commercial cooperation between the two countries. The study highlights significant potential across a wide range of sectors, including pharmaceuticals, fertilizers, heavy engineering, mining equipment, information technology, agriculture, food processing, renewable energy, biotechnology, logistics, automotive components, education, electronics, and infrastructure. While existing bilateral trade remains modest relative to the size and capabilities of both economies, the complementarities between India's expanding manufacturing and innovation ecosystem and Belarus's industrial and engineering expertise create a strong foundation for long-term collaboration.

Recognising the challenges posed by evolving geopolitical dynamics, global supply-chain realignments, and changing investment patterns, this report identifies actionable strategies that can help businesses navigate emerging opportunities while promoting mutually beneficial partnerships. It also outlines the important role that CCI India can play in facilitating business delegations, investment promotion, technology partnerships, policy dialogue, market intelligence, and institutional collaboration between stakeholders in both countries.

CCI India remains committed to serving as a trusted bridge between governments, industry, investors, and academic institutions. By fostering stronger business-to-business engagement and supporting strategic partnerships, we aim to contribute meaningfully to the next phase of India–Belarus economic relations.



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BELARUS

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Basic Facts and Economic Overview

Belarus is a landlocked country in Eastern Europe, with Minsk as its capital. As of 2025 projections, the population is approximately 9.0–9.1 million. Belarus operates under a presidential republic system and has close economic and political ties with Russia.

The economy is largely state-controlled, with significant government involvement in key industries such as manufacturing, agriculture, and energy. Belarus has a strong industrial base, particularly in machinery, tractors, chemicals, and fertilizers.

Economy — GDP, Structure & Recent Performance

Belarus's nominal GDP is estimated at approximately USD 75-95 billion (2025).

- Sectoral Composition: Industry: ~50%
- Services: ~40%
- Agriculture: ~8%

Economic growth has been modest, typically around 3.6–3.9% in 2023–24, slowing to ~1% in 2025, constrained by international sanctions and limited market diversification. The country remains heavily dependent on trade with Russia.

Bilateral Trade with India

Trade between India and Belarus is moderate, estimated at approximately USD 100–110 million annually (2024–25). India imports fertilizers and chemicals, while exporting pharmaceuticals, tea, and textiles.

Population

Belarus imports pharmaceuticals, tea, textiles, and small machinery, some of which originate from India either directly or through intermediaries. Direct exports from Belarus to India include fertilizers and chemicals, with additional trade routed through regional supply chains.



Cultural and Heritage

Belarus has a rich cultural heritage shaped by Slavic traditions, folk music, dance, and colorful festivals. The country is known for its historic castles, wooden churches, and traditional crafts like weaving and embroidery. Its culture reflects a strong connection to family values, rural life, and centuries-old customs passed through generations.

Import and Export from India

Belarus imports pharmaceuticals, tea, textiles, and small machinery, some of which originate from India either directly or through intermediaries. Direct exports from Belarus to India include fertilizers and chemicals, with additional trade routed through regional supply chains.

Strategic Importance and Key Observation

Belarus holds strategic importance as a transit corridor between Europe and Russia. However, geopolitical tensions and sanctions significantly affect its economic environment.

Opportunities and Risks for Indian Businesses

Opportunities:

- Fertilizer imports
- Pharmaceutical exports
- Machinery and industrial cooperation

Risks:

- Geopolitical instability
- Economic sanctions
- Limited market openness

Cultural and Strategic Economic Ties

India and Belarus share long-standing relations, particularly in pharmaceuticals, education, and defense cooperation. Belarus is a key supplier of potash fertilizers to India.

Conclusion – Summary & Recommendation

Belarus is a state-driven industrial economy with strategic importance in fertilizer supply.
India should focus on securing fertilizer supply chains while cautiously managing geopolitical risks.



Chapter 1: India–Belarus Bilateral Relations

1.1 Historical Relations and Diplomatic Engagement

India and the Republic of Belarus established diplomatic relations in 1992, in the immediate aftermath of Belarus's emergence as an independent state following the dissolution of the Soviet Union. India appointed its first Resident Ambassador to Belarus in January 1993, and Belarus reciprocated by opening its Embassy in New Delhi in 1998. Belarusian consular presence in India was subsequently widened through the establishment of an Honorary Consulate in Kolkata in December 2002 and an Honorary Consulate in Mumbai in September 2018, culminating in the inauguration of a full Belarusian Consulate General in Mumbai in August 2022. This steady deepening of diplomatic footprint reflects the importance both nations attach to expanding engagement beyond the political sphere into commerce, industry, science, and culture.

Over three decades, the relationship has matured into what both governments describe as a comprehensive partnership, characterised by regular political consultation, convergence on major multilateral issues, and an institutionalised architecture of bilateral mechanisms. This foundation of trust and continuity is precisely the kind of relationship on which a substantially larger economic partnership can now be constructed.

This diplomatic groundwork has proven especially valuable during periods of geopolitical turbulence, allowing both governments to maintain a stable channel for dialogue even as Belarus's relations with Western partners came under strain, and providing continuity for the institutional mechanisms described below.

1.2 Political Cooperation and Institutional Mechanisms

Political cooperation between India and Belarus is conducted through several standing mechanisms, most notably Foreign Office Consultations (FOCs), the Inter-Governmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Industrial, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation (IGC-TEC), and a Joint Commission on Military Technical Cooperation. The seventh round of FOCs was held in New Delhi in August 2022, chaired jointly by India's Secretary (West) and Belarus's First Deputy Foreign Minister. The eleventh session of the IGC-TEC took place on 10 November 2022, co-chaired by the Belarusian Foreign Minister and India's then Minister of State for Commerce & Industry, and included direct engagement with India's Minister of Commerce & Industry.

These mechanisms provide the institutional scaffolding through which trade and investment priorities are negotiated, and they represent an important entry point for CCI India to align its own industry engagement calendar with the government-to-government track, ensuring that private sector priorities are reflected in official deliberations.

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The IGC-TEC framework has also spawned sector-specific working arrangements in the past, including on pharmaceuticals and defence-technical cooperation, illustrating that the institutional appetite for deeper sectoral engagement already exists; what has been missing is a standing, business-facing body able to sustain momentum between formal government sessions.

1.3 Trade and Investment Relations

Bilateral trade between India and Belarus, while growing, remains modest relative to the potential of both economies. According to figures compiled by the Embassy of India in Minsk, bilateral trade stood at approximately USD 111.8 million in 2023 and USD 106.69 million in 2025, with the trade balance generally favouring Belarus on account of its potash fertiliser exports to India. India's own Ministry of Commerce data for the 2023–24 fiscal year records total bilateral trade closer to USD 59 million, with India recording a modest trade surplus for that period; the divergence between Indian and Belarusian reporting reflects differences in customs classification, re-routing of trade through third countries, and timing of fiscal-year versus calendar-year reporting, and underscores the need for a harmonised, jointly verified trade database a role CCI India is well positioned to support.

India's principal exports to Belarus include pharmaceuticals, machinery, organic chemicals, tea, coffee, and tobacco, while India's imports from Belarus are dominated by potash fertilisers, mining and earth-moving equipment, raw hides, and synthetic rubber. On the investment side, cooperation has so far been concentrated in pharmaceuticals: in 2016, Indian and Belarusian companies established three joint ventures in the pharmaceutical sector involving an initial Indian investment of approximately USD 3 million. The Government of India granted Belarus Market Economy Status in 2015, and during the state visit of the President of India to Belarus in June 2015, India extended a USD 100 million Line of Credit to support joint projects.

Beyond BelAZ and mining equipment, cooperation in heavy engineering has extended to periodic technical exchanges between Belarusian and Indian defence-linked manufacturing entities, reflecting the broader pattern of trust that underpins the relationship even in narrowly scoped domains.

1.4 Defence and Technical Cooperation (High-Level Overview)

Defence-technical cooperation forms an established, if narrowly scoped, pillar of the relationship, anchored by a bilateral agreement signed in 2003 and overseen by the Joint Commission on Military Technical Cooperation. Beyond defence, cooperation in mining and heavy engineering has produced tangible outcomes: BelAZ, Belarus's flagship manufacturer of heavy dump trucks, opened a service centre in Nagpur in May 2016, and its 240-tonne capacity trucks have been deployed by Indian company Triveni on infrastructure projects in Andhra Pradesh.

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